

Massachusetts School Building Authority

Next Steps to Finalize Submission of your 2024 Statement of Interest (“SOI”)

Thank you for submitting a 2024 SOI to the Massachusetts School Building Authority (the “MSBA”) electronically. **Please note, the District’s submission is not yet complete if the District selected Statutory Priority 1 or Statutory Priority 3.** If either of these priorities were selected, the District must post-mark and submit to the MSBA by the Core Program SOI filing period closure date the required supporting documentation to the MSBA, which is described below.

ADDITIONAL DOCUMENTATION REQUIRED FOR SOI STATUTORY PRIORITIES 1 AND 3 IN ORDER TO BE CONSIDERED COMPLETE:

- If the District selects Statutory Priority 1: Replacement or renovation of a building, which is structurally unsound or otherwise in a condition seriously jeopardizing the health and safety of the school children, where no alternative exists, the MSBA requires a hard copy of the engineering (or other) report detailing the nature and severity of the problem and a written professional opinion of how imminent the system failure is likely to manifest itself. The district also must submit photographs of the problematic building area or system to the MSBA. The SOI will not be considered complete unless this information is provided.
- If the District selects Statutory Priority 3: Prevention of a loss of accreditation, the SOI will not be considered complete unless a summary of the accreditation report focused on the deficiencies as stated in this SOI are provided.

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION: In addition to the information required above, the District may also provide reports, pictures, or other information they feel will give the MSBA a better understanding of the issues identified at a facility. The additional documentation must also be post-marked and submitted to the MSBA by the Core Program SOI filing period closure date.

If you have any questions about the SOI process please contact the MSBA at 617-720-4466 or SOI@massschoolbuildings.org.

Massachusetts School Building Authority

School District Amherst-Pelham

District Contact Rupert Roy-Clark Title: Director of Facilities Management TEL: (413) 362-1855

Name of School Amherst Regional Middle

School Address 170 Chestnut Street, Amherst, MA - 01002

Submission Date 3/1/2024

Statement of Interest (“SOI”) CERTIFICATION

To be eligible to submit an SOI, a district must certify the following:

- ☒ The district hereby acknowledges and agrees that this SOI is NOT an application for funding and that submission of this SOI in no way commits the MSBA to accept an application, approve an application, provide a grant or any other type of funding, or places any other obligation on the MSBA.
- ☒ The district hereby acknowledges that no district shall have any entitlement to funds from the MSBA, pursuant to M.G.L. c. 70B or the provisions of 963 CMR 2.00.
- ☒ The district hereby acknowledges that the provisions of 963 CMR 2.00 shall apply to the district and all projects for which the district is seeking and/or receiving funds for any portion of a municipally-owned or regionally-owned school facility from the MSBA pursuant to M.G.L. c. 70B.
- ☒ The district hereby acknowledges that this SOI is for one existing public school in the district that is currently used or will be used to educate public school students in grades Pre-K through 12 as reported to the Department of Elementary and Secondary Education (the “DESE”) and that the school for which the SOI is being submitted does not solely serve the district’s Pre-K student population.
- ☒ Prior to the submission of the SOI, the district will schedule and hold a meeting at which the School Committee will vote, using the specific language contained in the “Vote” tab, to authorize the submission of this SOI. This is required for cities, towns, and regional school districts.
- ☒ Prior to the submission of the SOI, the district will schedule and hold a meeting at which the City Council/Board of Aldermen or Board of Selectmen/equivalent governing body will vote, using the specific language contained in the “Vote” tab, to authorize the submission of this SOI. This is not required for regional school districts.
- ☒ The district hereby acknowledges that current vote documentation is required for all SOI submissions. The district will use the MSBA’s vote template and the required votes will specifically reference the school name and the Statutory Priorities for which the SOI is being submitted.
- ☒ The district hereby acknowledges that it must upload all required vote documentation on the “Vote” tab, in the format required by the MSBA. All votes must be certified or signed and on city, town or district letterhead.
- ☒ The district hereby acknowledges that this SOI submission will not be complete until the MSBA has received all required supporting documentation for Statutory Priority 1 and/or Statutory Priority 3, if either is selected. If Statutory Priority 1 is selected, the district’s SOI will not be considered complete unless and until the district provides the required engineering (or other) report, a professional opinion regarding the problem, and photographs of the problematic area or system. If Statutory Priority 3 is selected, the district’s SOI will not be considered complete unless and until the district provides a summary of the accreditation report focused on the deficiencies as stated in this SOI. The documentation noted above must be post-marked and submitted to the MSBA by the Core Program SOI filing period closure date.

**LOCAL CHIEF EXECUTIVE OFFICER/DISTRICT SUPERINTENDENT/SCHOOL COMMITTEE CHAIR
(E.g., Mayor, Town Manager, Board of Selectmen)**

Chief Executive Officer *

School Committee Chair

Superintendent of Schools

Douglas Slaughter

Sarahbess Kenney

Douglas Slaughter

Superintendent




(signature)

(signature)

(signature)

Date

Date

Date

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* Local Chief Executive Officer: In a city or town with a manager form of government, the manager of the municipality; in other cities, the mayor; and in other towns, the board of selectmen unless, in a city or town, some other municipal office is designated to the chief executive office under the provisions of a local charter. Please note, in districts where the Superintendent is also the Local Chief Executive Officer, it is required for the same person to sign the Statement of Interest Certifications twice.

Massachusetts School Building Authority

School District Amherst-Pelham

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Note

SOI Program: Accelerated Repair
Potential Project Scope: Accelerated Repair
Roof

The following summary of the Statutory Priorities as set forth in M.G.L. c. 70B, § 8 have been included in the Statement of Interest (for the Core Program, select as many as are applicable):

1. ☐ Replacement or renovation of a building which is structurally unsound or otherwise in a condition seriously jeopardizing the health and safety of school children, where no alternative exists.
2. ☐ Elimination of existing severe overcrowding.
3. ☐ Prevention of the loss of accreditation.
4. ☐ Prevention of severe overcrowding expected to result from increased enrollment.
5. ☒ Replacement, renovation or modernization of school facility systems, such as roofs, windows, boilers, heating and ventilation systems, to increase energy conservation and decrease energy related costs in a school facility.
6. ☐ Short term enrollment growth.
7. ☐ Replacement of or addition to obsolete buildings in order to provide for a full range of programs consistent with state and approved local requirements.
8. ☐ Transition from court-ordered and approved racial balance school districts to walk-to, so-called, or other school districts.

SOI Vote Requirement

☒ I acknowledge that I have reviewed the MSBA's vote requirements for submitting an SOI, which are set forth in the Vote Tab of this SOI. I understand that the MSBA requires votes from specific governing bodies, in a format **using the language provided by the MSBA**. Further, I understand that the MSBA requires certified and signed vote documentation to be submitted with the SOI. I acknowledge that my SOI will not be considered complete and, therefore, will not be reviewed by the MSBA unless the required accompanying vote documentation is submitted in a form that is acceptable to the MSBA. All SOI vote documentation must be uploaded on the Vote Tab.

Each district must prioritize one Core Program Statement of Interest from all of the Statements of Interest that the district has submitted or prepopulated, including any SOIs that may be in the MSBA's capital pipeline. **At no time shall a district have more than one prioritized SOI on file with the MSBA.**

Is this SOI the District Priority SOI? Yes

School name of the District Priority SOI: 2024 Amherst Regional Middle

Is this part of a larger Master Facilities Plan and/or Educational Plan within the past five years that includes facility goals for this building and all school buildings in the District? Yes

If "YES", please provide the following:

Facilities Plan Date: 1/31/2023

Planning Firm: In-House

Please provide a brief summary of the plan(s) including its goals and how the school facility that is the subject of this SOI fits into that plan:

The District has a ten year capital plan which includes the Middle School and High School. The District reviews and updates the capital plan each year and the school committee approves the upcoming years projects.

Provide, if applicable, the most recent budget approval process that resulted in an operating budget reduction and the impact of the reduction to the school district (staff reductions, discontinued programs, consolidation of facilities). Please provide a description of the program modifications as a consequence of these teacher and/or staff reductions, including the impact on district class sizes and curriculum. If no recent teacher layoffs and/or staff reductions have occurred, please enter "Does Not Apply".

Does Not Apply

Please provide a description of the local actions and approvals needed to secure both funding for a feasibility study and project funding for a potential building project with the MSBA. Please include schedule information for both funding actions(i.e. Town Meeting, City Council/Town Council meetings, Regional School Committee Meetings).

Each year in March, the Regional School Committee votes a debt authorization to fund capital projects. Member towns have 60 days to hold a town meeting to express approval/disapproval or take no action which is considered approval. Amherst recently changed its form of government to a town council so it would hold a town council meeting within 60 days. On March 12, 2019 the Regional School Committee voted to approve debt authorization for \$3 million for this Middle School roof project, and the Amherst Town Council approved on April 22, 2019. The Town meetings of the member towns on April 27th, May 4th, and May 11th of 2019 also approved the debt authorization for this potential capital project.

General Description

BRIEF BUILDING HISTORY: Please provide a detailed description of when the original building was built, and the date(s) and project scopes(s) of any additions and renovations including modular units (maximum of 5000 characters).

The building was built in 1969. In 2002 there was a partial renovation done to the exterior of the school. Some exterior doors were changed to comply with ADA regulations. An energy audit was performed on the building by the DOER. It was noted that there was air infiltration due to aging windows and doors. The windows and doors were replaced in 2012. In general the building is in pretty good condition.

TOTAL BUILDING SQUARE FOOTAGE: Please provide the original building square footage PLUS the square footage of any additions (field one below) and/or modular units (field two below).

Original Building Plus Additions Square Footage 197000
Modular Units Square Footage 0

SITE DESCRIPTION: Please provide a detailed description of the current site, including confirming the address of the school, who has ownership, control, and use of the site, and any known existing conditions that would impact a potential project at the site. Please note whether there are any other buildings, public or private, that share this current site with the school and/or if there are multiple schools housed within the same building. What is the use(s) of this building(s)? (maximum of 5000 characters).

The building is located at 170 Chestnut Street, Amherst Massachusetts. It is owned and operated by the Amherst Pelham Regional School District. The site is open with plenty of sunlight. There are minor ground water issues due to a sloped hill on the east side of the building. There are no other buildings on the site but a Town department (Amherst Recreation) does use a small amount of space within the Middle School.

BUILDING ENVELOPE: Please provide a detailed description of the building envelope, types of construction materials used, and any known problems or existing conditions (maximum of 5000 characters).

The building has block / brick enclosure with a PVC roof. There are some stress cracks in the brick and block walls from water damage they are in very good condition otherwise. Roof splits and resulting leaks have become more and more prevalent in the past few years. New windows and doors were installed in 2012. Capstones have been repaired and one chimney was re-built in 2018. A major patch and seal repair project was performed in 2023 to buy a little more time for the failing roof.

Has there been a Major Repair or Replacement of the EXTERIOR WALLS? NO
Year of Last Major Repair or Replacement:(YYYY)
Description of Last Major Repair or Replacement:

Total Roof Square Footage 128340

Roof Section A

Is the District seeking replacement of the Roof Section? YES

Area of Section (square feet) 111090

Type of ROOF (e.g., PVC, EPDM, Shingle, Slate, Tar & Gravel, Other (please describe)
PVC

Age of Section (number of years since the Roof was installed or replaced) 30

Description of repairs, if applicable, in the last three years. Include year of repair:
lots of patching and application of sealers

Roof Section B**Is the District seeking replacement of the Roof Section?** YES**Area of Section (square feet)** 17250**Type of ROOF (e.g., PVC, EPDM, Shingle, Slate, Tar & Gravel, Other (please describe))**
PVC**Age of Section (number of years since the Roof was installed or replaced)** 23**Description of repairs, if applicable, in the last three years. Include year of repair:**
lots of patching and caulking splits and seams.**Total Window Count** 416**Window Section A****Is the District seeking replacement of the Windows Section?** NO**Windows in Section (count)****Type of WINDOWS (e.g., Single Pane, Double Pane, Other (please describe))****Age of Section (number of years since the Windows were installed or replaced)****Description of repairs, if applicable, in the last three years. Include year of repair:****MECHANICAL and ELECTRICAL SYSTEMS: Please provide a detailed description of the current mechanical and electrical systems and any known problems or existing conditions (maximum of 5000 characters).**

The HVAC system is under computer control. The building has a three boiler system. One boiler is new as of 2018, the second was from 2002 but re-sectioned in 2010 and the third is from 2002. The boilers have dual fuel capacity but the District has converted entirely to natural gas. The chillers are original from 1969. The main electrical switch gear and main distribution system are original from 1969.

are original from 1969.

Has there been a Major Repair or Replacement of the HVAC SYSTEM? YES**Year of Last Major Repair or Replacement:(YYYY)** 2018**Description of Last Major Repair or Replacement:**

One of three dual fuel boilers was replaced in 2018.

During a 2003 building renovation, the following improvements were made: new classroom uni-vents, new air handling equipment for the principal and superintendent office suites, new exhaust fans for eight classrooms and fresh air makeup system replaced for eight inner classrooms.

Has there been a Major Repair or Replacement of the ELECTRICAL SERVICES AND DISTRIBUTION SYSTEM? YES**Year of Last Major Repair or Replacement:(YYYY)** 2003**Description of Last Major Repair or Replacement:**

In 2003, the building generator was replaced. In 2008, a supplemental generator for Information Technology was installed. Also in 2017, all exterior and site lighting was upgraded to LED and we added 2 electric vehicle charging stations. Interior lighting was upgraded to LED over the past 5 years.

BUILDING INTERIOR: Please provide a detailed description of the current building interior including a description of the flooring systems, finishes, ceilings, lighting, etc. (maximum of 5000 characters).

Internal building is in very good shape. A renovation in 2002/2003 addressed much of the building. The flooring is VCT on the second floor and a mix of terrazzo and VCT on the first floor. Most of the building has drop ceilings.

SPACES AND PROGRAMS: Please provide a description of the number and sizes (in square feet) of all spaces. Please also provide the current grade structure and programs offered. If a vocational or comprehensive high school offering Chapter 74 Programs and/or Career Technical Education, please include the number of programs currently offered (maximum of 5000 characters).

The building serves grade 7 and 8 from Amherst, Pelham, Leverett, and Shutesbury. The school offers a wide array of programs from core subjects to the arts and beyond. The Academic Individualized Mainstream Support (AIMS) program and the Bridges program for middle school students are also housed within the building. In addition, The District Family Center and Central Offices are also located in this building.

The roof leaks have not prevented the offering of certain program components. That said, roof leaks are over the classrooms, auditorium, library and gym, and have created disruptions in learning. In some cases roof leaks have damaged some asbestos-containing materials, requiring temporary closure of spaces for abatement and mitigation.

TOTAL SCHOOL STUDENT ENROLLMENT: Please provide the current student enrollment at the school as of the SOI filing. 369

CURRENT GRADES SERVED AT SOI FACILITY: 7,8

SCHOOL TYPE: Regional

CAPACITY and UTILIZATION: Please provide the original design capacity and a detailed description of the current capacity and utilization of the school facility. Please also describe in detail any spaces that have been converted from their intended use to be used as classroom space (maximum of 5000 characters).

There is capacity in the building. In the 70's an additional grade used this facility. The District anticipates moving 6th grade classes into the building for Amherst students in the Fall of 2025.

Is there overcrowding at the school facility? NO

If "YES", please describe in detail, including specific examples of the overcrowding and describe steps taken by the administration to address capacity issues.

Please provide the current student to teacher ratios at the school facility that is the subject of this SOI (# students per teacher) 8

Please indicate if the ratio is a goal, practice or a class size policy adopted by the School Committee
This is our current ratio at the Middle School as reported to DESE.

Please provide the originally planned student to teacher ratios at the school facility that is the subject of this SOI (# students per teacher)

MAINTENANCE and CAPITAL REPAIR: Please provide a detailed description of the district's current maintenance practices within the past five years, its capital repair program, and the maintenance program in place at the facility that is the subject of this SOI. Please include specific examples of capital repair projects undertaken in the past, including any override or debt exclusion votes that were necessary (maximum of 5000 characters).

The building has been repaired largely using operating funds. There are onsite professional maintenance staff who perform preventative maintenance and respond to repair calls.

A 10 year Capital Plan has been written to allocate funds and make repairs to the facility. Recent capital projects include elevator upgrade (FY24); transportation software (FY24); catch basin repairs (FY23); IR scanning Electric Service & Distribution (FY24); removal of an Underground Storage Tank for Heating Fuel Oil (FY23); structural analysis for rooftop Photovoltaics (FY23); a kitchen hot water boiler replacement (FY23); south end mechanical room design and abatement (FY19). A boiler was replaced in 2018, windows and doors were replaced in 2012. The generators were installed in 2003 and 2008.

None required a override or debt exclusion.

Priority 5

Question 1: Please provide a detailed description of the issues surrounding the school facility systems (e.g., roof, windows, boilers, HVAC system, and/or electrical service and distribution system) that you are indicating require repair or replacement. Please describe all deficiencies to all systems in sufficient detail to explain the problem.

If a response has been previously provided, please reference which page the information is on in lieu of copying and pasting. The responses per Priority should capture new or different information than previously provided within this document.

The roof section over the educational classrooms on the second floor, the gymnasium locker room and pool (last replaced circa 1994) are brittle and aging PVC. The roofs were constructed with very little slope in some sections, accelerating the need for repairs. The periods of heating and cooling in the Fall and Spring have created multiple splits in our Sarnafil roof. District staff have done a good job reacting to leaks once they occur and do their best to proactively seek out potential leaks. In recent years, the location and number of leaks has grown making it almost impossible to be proactive. When we get a wintery mix it results in a couple inches of slush sitting on the roof for a period of time. Because there is very little slope, the slush does not run off. This contributes to many leaks throughout the building, one right in the center of the library and several in classrooms. Classrooms have had to be reconfigured so students do not sit under a leaking area. Computers have been damaged. There may be further damage to the building that is not visible.

In addition, the roof over the Auditorium (last replaced circa 2002) has been having more and more leaks. This roof, also made of Sarnafil, is having splits and seam failures, particularly at the rain diverters. In the last two years the auditorium had to be closed for all uses several times, once for over a month because of the leaks. This auditorium is normally used daily for classes.

Priority 5

Question 2: Please describe the measures the district has already taken to mitigate the problem/issues described in Question 1 above.

If a response has been previously provided, please reference which page the information is on in lieu of copying and pasting. The responses per Priority should capture new or different information than previously provided within this document.

The District employs in-house staff and one in particular that spends much of his time monitoring and repairing our roofs. This employee patches leaks/potential leaks before and after they occur. In the fall of 2023 we had contractors perform approximately \$200,000 in repairs to the roof, masonry and flashing to buy more time before the roof replacement project.

Nevertheless, new leaks are constantly developing, principally from new splits in the PVC

Priority 5

Question 3: Please provide a detailed explanation of the impact of the problem/issues described in Question 1 above on your district's educational program. Please include specific examples of how the problem prevents the district from delivering the educational program it is required to deliver and how students and/or teachers are directly affected by the problem identified.

If a response has been previously provided, please reference which page the information is on in lieu of copying and pasting. The responses per Priority should capture new or different information than previously provided within this document.

The roof section of the educational wing is the primary problem as it directly impacts student comfort and learning. Classrooms have had multiple leaks and the classroom needs to be reconfigured so that students are not leaked on until the patching can be completed. The library had a significant leak directly in the middle that created additional obstacles to the regular function of the library. Computers have been damaged because of leaks directly above them.

In addition, the leaks in the auditorium roof penetrated the plaster ceiling and caused areas of asbestos-containing acoustical treatment to bubble up and become flaky. This space was consequently closed for abatement. Future leaks could well penetrate other, unabated locations in the auditorium, causing future closures. This is the only large assembly space in the building, and the only area capable of all-school assemblies. Furthermore, it is an essential part of band, chorus and theater classes and projects.

Leaks over the gym spaces have forced closure of gym spaces and the cancellation of programs and classes that would use that space.

Priority 5

Question 4: Please describe how addressing the school facility systems you identified in Question 1 above will extend the useful life of the facility and how it will improve your district's educational program.

If a response has been previously provided, please reference which page the information is on in lieu of copying and pasting. The responses per Priority should capture new or different information than previously provided within this document.

Replacing these sections of the roof will significantly extend the life of the building because many of the other components of the building are in pretty good shape. The windows and doors were replaced about a decade ago, sections of the boiler have been replaced very recently, the building envelope is still strong. The district is beginning to plan for an electrical system upgrade, chiller replacement and parking lot work in the next ten years.

Replacing the roof will provide students with a comfortable and safe learning environment free from unnecessary distractions. It will also preserve district assets and minimize problems that may be occurring out of sight.

One of our member towns is in the process of building a new elementary school, which makes any replacement of this building in the near future highly unlikely. In addition, the District is currently planning to bring another grade into the school building, which will increase the number of students in this building.

Bringing roof insulation up to current code as part of the re-roofing project will reduce energy costs in the future and help the member towns achieve climate goals.

If not located elsewhere in this SOI, please also provide the following information:

Have the systems identified above been examined by an engineer or other trained building professional?:
YES

If "YES", please provide the name of the individual and his/her professional affiliation (maximum of 250 characters):

Gale Associates Inc. of Rockland Mass performed two studies: the oldest sections of roof were covered in a report dated December 12, 2017. The newer auditorium section was covered in a report dated July 1, 2022.

The date of the inspection: 7/1/2022

A summary of the findings (maximum of 5000 characters):

2017: Gale provided a 30% Schematic Design that outlines their recommendations for replacing the Roof Section A above, covering the classroom wing and the pool and gymnasium. A copy of this report is available upon request. The report recommendations include removing all membrane, insulation, vapor retarder and associated components down to the roof deck. To meet current insulation requirements, much of the flashing also must be replaced along with perimeter wood blocking and sheet metal edge fascia, and numerous curbs for roof hatches and mechanical equipment. The majority of the drain bowls and sleeves to the rain leaders need replacing. Also, numerous masonry repairs are needed.

2022 Report evaluated roof Section B above, covering the Auditorium and associated hallways. A copy of this report is available upon request. In summary, Gale recommends replacement of the roof circa 2025-2027, similar to the other roof sections.

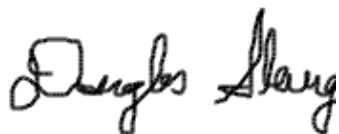
CERTIFICATIONS

The undersigned hereby certifies that, to the best of his/her knowledge, information and belief, the statements and information contained in this statement of Interest and submitted hereto are true and accurate and that this Statement of Interest has been prepared under the direction of the district school committee and the undersigned is duly authorized to submit this Statement of Interest to the Massachusetts School Building Authority. The undersigned also hereby acknowledges and agrees to provide the Massachusetts School Building Authority, upon request by the Authority, any additional information relating to this Statement of Interest that may be required by the Authority.

Chief Executive Officer *

Douglas Slaughter

Superintendent



(signature)

Date

3/1/2024 4:46:21 PM

School Committee Chair

Sarahbess Kenney

(signature)

Date

3/1/2024 5:31:38 PM

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